



AI Design Lab: Solving Problems Together

Participant Guide
Parts 1 & 2

Name:
Role:
Team:
Date:

This participant guide will support your work during the AI Design Lab training. It contains lab instructions, sample prompts, workspace for your notes, and debrief questions for peer review. Come prepared to challenge yourself and experiment with creating new workflows.

How to Use This Guide

Everyone's a Builder

The AI Design Lab is where you stop asking 'what can AI do?' and start asking 'what can I build with it?'

Work through each section in order as you follow along with your facilitator. The guide contains:

- Lab instructions and step-by-step prompts for each hands-on activity.
- Sample prompts you can copy and customize in SlackBot or your preferred AI tool.
- Workspace to capture your ideas, problems, and workflows.
- Peer review debrief questions to use after each lab.

Keep this guide after training. The workflows you create here are yours to use immediately.

AI Tools

The workflows described in this training were designed with the following tools in mind:

- SlackBot
- Gemini
- NotebookLM
- Cursor
- AgentForce

There may be additional AI tools approved for your function or team. Review the [current list of approved AI tools in Basecamp](#).



Part 1 Training: Labs #1 and #2

LAB #1

Define Your Business Problem

In this lab, you will identify up to three real business problems in your role that could benefit from a Human + AI workflow. The goal is to practice problem framing before problem solving.

	20 minutes: Individual brainstorming
	10 minutes: Peer Review

Problem-Framing Questions

Before diving in, apply these framing questions to push your thinking deeper:

- What is the real problem I am trying to solve?
- Is this my problem alone, or a system/team problem?
- What has already been tried?
- What would I lose, or what would change if I solved this problem?
- Ask "Why?" five times to get to the root of the issue.

Sample Prompt for SlackBot

SAMPLE PROMPT TO IDENTIFY BUSINESS PROBLEMS

Copy, paste and customize this prompt in SlackBot:

Part 1 Prompt:

Name my role, focus area, team goals, and main responsibilities. I'll help you revise, then we'll move on to identifying workflows that would benefit from AI tools.

Part 2 Prompt:

I want to identify the top 3 business problems in my role that would benefit most from creating a workflow with AI tools. The time period to gather data is **[INSERT TIME FRAME HERE]**.

For each business problem, please prioritize ones that are:

- **Time-consuming:** takes significant manual effort to complete
- **Repetitive:** done frequently with a similar process each time
- **Information-heavy:** requires gathering, synthesizing, or summarizing large amounts of content

My Business Problems

Brainstorm up to three problems below. You will select one to develop into a workflow in Lab #2.

Business Problem 1

Business Problem 2

Business Problem 3

Problem I selected, and why:

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PEER REVIEW — DEBRIEF QUESTIONS

- 1. Share your three problems. Which one felt hardest to define clearly, and why?
- 2. Which problem did you select to develop further? What made it stand out?
- 3. What is the root cause of the problem you selected? Did the 5 Whys reveal anything unexpected?
- 4. Is this primarily your problem to solve, or does it involve a system or team issue? How does that affect your approach?

Peer Review Notes

Overview

Using the business problem you selected in Lab 1, you will map out a complete workflow by identifying each step, the best method (Human, AI, or both), the right tool, and the potential ROI.

	30 minutes: Individual brainstorming
	10 minutes: Peer Review

Workflow Creation Steps

1	Select the business problem from Lab 1 (or you can brainstorm a new one!).
2	Identify every step required to complete the task from start to finish. Consider: What triggers the workflow? Where are the decision points?
3	Determine the method for each step: Human, AI only, or Human + AI.
4	Assign a tool to each step: SlackBot, Gemini, NotebookLM, Cursor, or other.
5	Estimate what you think will be the ROI: time saved, quality improved, efficiency gained, or meaningful work enabled. (Remember, at this stage ROI is a best guess.)

Method Guide

HUMAN	HUMAN + AI	AI
- Analyzing social or political context. - Being accountable for a decision. - Building trust or relationships.	AI computational power combined with human judgment to evaluate, redirect, or apply the output.	- Pattern recognition across large data. - Generating multiple options quickly. - Formatting or structuring information. - Retrieving and synthesizing content.

Sample Prompt to Use in SlackBot to Identify Workflows

SAMPLE PROMPT

Part 1 Prompt:

Name my role, focus area, team goals, and main responsibilities. I'll help you revise, then we'll move on to identifying workflows that would benefit from AI tools.

Part 2 Prompt:

I want to identify the top 3 business workflows in my role that would benefit most from AI tools. For each workflow, prioritize ones that are:

- Time-consuming — takes significant manual effort to complete
- Repetitive — done frequently with a similar process each time
- Information-heavy — requires gathering, synthesizing, or summarizing large amounts of content

For each workflow: Name and describe it, explain which criteria it meets, and recommend a specific AI tool (For example SlackBot, Gemini, NotebookLM, or other) and describe how you'd use it.

My Workflow

Use the table below to map out your workflow.

Business Problem I am solving:

Step	Action	Method (Human / AI / Both)	Tool	ROI Notes
1				
2				

3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				

Estimated ROI Summary:

PEER REVIEW — DEBRIEF QUESTIONS

1. Walk your partner through your workflow step by step. Which step felt most uncertain to define?

2. For each step, did you find it easy to decide between Human, Human + AI, and AI? Where was it a close call?

3. Which tool did you assign to each AI step? What was your reasoning?

4. What ROI do you expect from this workflow? Is it primarily time savings, quality, or something else?

5. What would need to be true for this workflow to actually be adopted by your team?



Part 2 Training: Labs #3 and #4

LAB 3

Refine or Create a New Workflow

Overview

In Lab 3 you will create a more complex workflow. It's up to you how you select this more complex workflow. You can:

1. Return to your Part 1 workflow and add more steps to increase the complexity, OR brainstorm a brand new, complex workflow.
2. Use the prompt below for SlackBot to help identify a new workflow.

As you build or refine, you will also experiment with attribution prompting and evaluating the quality of AI output.

	30 minutes: Individual brainstorming
	10 minutes: Peer Review

Sample Prompt for SlackBot

SAMPLE PROMPT TO IDENTIFY BUSINESS PROBLEMS

Copy, paste and customize this prompt in SlackBot:

Part 1 Prompt:

Name my role, focus area, team goals, and main responsibilities. I'll help you revise, then we'll move on to identifying workflows that would benefit from AI tools.

Part 2 Prompt:

I want to identify the top 3 business problems in my role that would benefit most from creating a workflow with AI tools. The time period to gather data is **[INSERT TIME FRAME HERE]**.

For each business problem, please prioritize ones that are:

- **Time-consuming:** takes significant manual effort to complete
- **Repetitive:** done frequently with a similar process each time

Information-heavy: requires gathering, synthesizing, or summarizing large amounts of content

Attribution Prompting

Attribution prompting asks the AI to be transparent about its sources and confidence level. Add one of the following to any prompt:

ATTRIBUTION PROMPT ADD-ONS

Option A:

"For each point, tell me whether this is based on data you were trained on, general industry research, or your own inference, and flag if you're uncertain about any of it."

Option B:

"Answer the question and tell me how confident you are in each point."

Challenges to AI Output Quality

After running your workflow, keep these common quality issues in mind:

Hallucinations	When a model outputs content that sounds plausible but is factually incorrect.
AI Slop	A first response that sounds complete but is actually a generic response and lacks depth.
Sycophantic	The model aligns with the user's assumptions rather than giving accurate information.
Over-Confident	The model delivers content with the same tone of confidence whether it is correct or not.

Output Quality Scorecard

After running your workflow, evaluate the quality of each step's output on a scale of 1 – 5 (low to high).

Quality Criteria:

- **Accurate:** Content is correct and can be verified.
- **Relevant:** Content is appropriate output for this workflow step.

- Coherent: Content is logical and not repetitive.
- Bias Mitigation: Content is fair and reflects the intended audience.

Content Type Score 1 – 5 (1=low, 5=high)	Accurate	Relevant	Coherent	Bias Check	Level of Human Review (low, medium or high)
Step 1 output					
Step 2 output					
Step 3 output					
Step 4 output					

Level of human review required for this workflow output (Low / Medium / High) and why:

My Refined/Updated Workflow

What I changed or improved in my workflow from Part 1:

Step	Action	Method (Human, AI, or both)	Tool	ROI Notes
1				

2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				

PEER REVIEW — DEBRIEF QUESTIONS

1. What process did you follow to create your more complex workflow, and what prompted those changes?
2. Did attribution prompting change the quality or usefulness of the AI output? If so, in what way?
3. How did you assess the quality of the output? Was any of the output quality inaccurate, irrelevant, incoherent, or biased?
4. What level of human review did you assign and did your colleague agree? Where do you differ?

LAB 4

Stress-Test Your Workflow

Overview

In this lab, you will use three prompting strategies to rigorously test your workflow. The goal is to uncover assumptions, predict failure points, and surface blind spots before you implement.

	40 minutes: Individual brainstorming
	10 minutes: Peer Review

The Three Stress-Test Prompts

VERIFIER	Tests assumptions in each step by asking which claims could be wrong and how to check them.
PRE-MORTEM	Predicts failure by assuming the workflow has already failed and identifies why.
ROLE-PLAY	Proves and defends by asking a skeptical stakeholder to critique the workflow.

Prompt 1 — Verifier

VERIFIER PROMPT

Paste your workflow steps into the AI, then add:

"Which of those claims could be wrong, and how would I check them?"

What assumptions did the verifier prompt challenge?

Prompt 2 — Pre-Mortem

PRE-MORTEM PROMPT

Paste your workflow steps, then add:

"Assume it is 6 months from now and this workflow has failed. What are the five most likely reasons it failed? What warning signs would have appeared in the first 30 days?"

Top failure risks identified:

30-day warning signs:

Prompt 3 — Role-Play

ROLE-PLAY PROMPT

Paste your workflow steps, then add:

"Act as a skeptical senior manager who has seen workflow initiatives fail in the past two years. Review this workflow and tell me exactly what you would push back on in a review meeting, what you believe employees will ignore or shortcut, and what you'd need to see before you'd consider this workflow trustworthy."

What the skeptical manager pushed back on:

What I would need to demonstrate to earn trust:

Workflow Improvements

Based on all three stress tests, note the changes you plan to make.

Changes I will make to improve the workflow:

PEER REVIEW — DEBRIEF QUESTIONS

1. Which of the three prompts: Verifier, Pre-Mortem, or Role-Play, was most useful for your workflow? Why?
2. Did different prompts surface different types of issues, or did they mostly overlap?
3. What was the most surprising or uncomfortable thing the stress tests revealed?
4. What is the one change you are most confident you will make to your workflow as a result of this lab?
5. How would you use these three prompting strategies in your own work outside of this training?

NEXT STEPS

Save and Apply Your Workflow

After the training, save your workflow to the team channel so it can be used, shared, and improved over time.

HOW TO SAVE YOUR WORKFLOW

1. Join the private Slack channel: #ai-design-lab-solving-problems-together
2. Click on Workflow and complete the form fields to describe your workflow.
3. Post to the chat: What is one thing from this training you plan to implement right away?
4. Complete the training evaluation.

Next Steps

One thing I will implement from this training within the next 30 days:

One workflow I will share with my team:
